Text Discovery on Google AI Overview Pages: Closing a Selector Coverage Gap

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Abstract, SpoilFree did not blur text inside the Google AI Overview because its element selector searched only paragraph, list-item and heading tags. This report describes the cause, a Google-specific text discovery routine that does not rely on class names and the results observed afterwards, including one paragraph that stayed unblurred for a reason attributed to the model score.

Index Terms, DOM scanning, content script, Google Search, MutationObserver, Chrome extension.

I. Introduction

A content script reads text from the page it runs on [1]. The first version selected p, li, h1 to h3 and two Reddit-specific containers. That set works on articles and forums but does not match the markup of generated answer boxes.

II. Problem Description

The developer reported that Google AI Overview text was not blurred while other pages were. The overview places its text in generic containers and a single sentence can be split across several inline elements such as bold or italic runs. Class names on such pages are generated and change often, so selectors based on them would break soon.

III. Implemented Solution

On Google hostnames the script walks all elements and keeps those whose text is between 40 and 500 characters and that have no child holding 40 or more characters, which gives the smallest element that contains a whole passage. If that element is inline, the script climbs to the nearest block ancestor using the computed display value [2]. Forms, inputs, navigation, scripts, styles and list boxes are skipped. A mutation observer, debounced by 500 ms, rescans the page while the overview is still being written [3]. Other sites keep the original selector.

IV. Verification

A fake page reproduced the structure: a heading, list items with a bold lead-in, an editable block and a plain paragraph. The routine returned the list items and the paragraph and skipped the editable block. After deployment the developer's screenshots showed blurred bullet lists in the overview. In a later query about a 1992 film, the first summary paragraph stayed unblurred while the bullets below it were blurred. The likely cause is a confidence below the movie bar for hedged summary wording; this was not confirmed with console output and is addressed in the training reports.

V. Conclusion

Matching by text size and structure, not by class name, closed the coverage gap and is more likely to survive layout changes. Coverage is not the same as detection, so recall on summary-style prose depends on the model.

References

[1] Google, "Content scripts," Chrome for Developers. Accessed: Oct. 28, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://developer.chrome.com/docs/extensions/develop/concepts/content-scripts

[2] Mozilla, "Window: getComputedStyle() method," MDN Web Docs. Accessed: Oct. 28, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://developer.mozilla.org/en-US/docs/Web/API/Window/getComputedStyle

[3] Mozilla, "MutationObserver," MDN Web Docs. Accessed: Oct. 28, 2026. [Online]. Available: https://developer.mozilla.org/en-US/docs/Web/API/MutationObserver